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Next year, you're the speaker!

Boosterconf 2026

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Relax, we won’t force anyone to improvise a talk during the workshop

«I have nothing to talk about!»

«I don’t know where to start!»

«What if I forget everything!»

The purpose of this workshop
is to help you get rid of those excuses

Group exercise

Tell the group about the best conference talk you have ever seen.

What made it so good?

Agenda

Part 1

- Intro to workshop
- Talk: What is a lightning talk?
- Idea generation workshop

Break ☕ (10:30-10:50)

Part 2

- Talk: How to write good abstracts
- Abstract writing workshop
- Where can you submit your talk?

Lunch and yoga (12:20)

What does that mean in practice?

In the first part, you will brainstorm and develop talk ideas

In the second part, you will write abstracts for the talk

Hopefully, some of you will want to submit the talks to a conference

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What is a lightning talk?

A lightning talk is short talk

Typically 5-10 minutes long

Timing is strict

You're cut off when your slot ends

It’s a good way to get into public speaking

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"

If I am to speak ten minutes,
I need a week for preparation
If fifteen minutes, three days
If half an hour, two days
If an hour, I am ready now.

Woodrow Wilson, President of the United States 1913-1921

It’s a hard format to master,

but a practice run only takes 10 minutes

What makes a lightning talk good?

Short, focused, one idea only

It’s not a lecture, tell a story with a clear takeaway

Make it personal

Prepare, prepare, prepare

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Why should I (of all people) give a talk?

You have something to share!

Sure, someone have probably said it before,

but not from your unique perspective

Giving and preparing a talk is a great way to learn

To improve your speaking and presenting skills

You get to go to conferences

It helps your career

Finding a good topic for a talk

Strong opinons make good topics

Things you have learned the hard way

Things people always ask you about

Can you bring insights from another field?

Geeky topics you explore on your spare time

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Idea generation workshop

Individually

Use the trigger questions

Write down everything that comes to mind

http://andrev.github.io/speaker-workshop/

In groups

Share your ideas

Ask «Tell me more»

Help each other select the most interesting ideas

Individually (or pair up on an idea)

Fill out the talk idea sheet for the idea you chose

Feel free to discuss in your group

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Pitch

Share your idea with everyone (voluntary)

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Break ☕

Until 10:50

From idea to abstract

The abstract (or talk description) should make the conference want to accept your talk, and the attendees want to attend it.

The anatomy of a good abstract

Hook
- why is this relevant?

Problem
- what is the challenge?

Solution
- what is your solution?

Takeaway
- what will people learn?

Target group
- who is this for?

Microservices and Why They Matter

This talk will cover microservices. We'll look at what they are, why they're important, and how to use them. I'll go through the pros and cons and share some best practices. Whether you're new to microservices or have been working with them for a while, there will be something for everyone.

By the end, you'll have a better understanding of microservices and how they can help your team.

How to Speak at Conferences

This workshop will cover how to become a conference speaker. We'll go through the basics of finding a topic, writing an abstract, and preparing a presentation.

Whether you're an experienced speaker or just getting started, this session has something for everyone. By the end, you'll feel more confident about submitting to conferences.

Next year, you're the speaker!

There is no better way to attend a conference than being a speaker. You get a free ticket, bragging rights, and best of all, the conference will treat you like royalty. You might even be invited to a fancy speakers' dinner.

But let's be honest: it's terrifying! "I have nothing to talk about!" "I don't know where to start!" "What if I forget everything and just stand there!"

The purpose of this workshop is to help you get rid of those excuses. It doesn't matter if you've held a talk before, or this will be your very first. You don't need a to bring a talk idea. If you don't think anyone would want to hear what you have to say, this is very much for you.

When we're done, you'll have the start of your talk, and maybe even the spark (or panic) that makes you want to give it.

GenAI is your friend, but don't go overboard

- Use it to critique your suggestion and suggest rewrites, but don't be tempted to - write it from scratch with AI
- Remember the the program comittee often has hundreds of abstracts to read, and can smell AI from afar
- You need to stand out in the crowd to get accepted
- Use your own critical thinking skills

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Abstract writing exercise

Individually (or pair up on an idea)

Write an abstract for your idea

- Use the «anatomy of an abstract» outline
- Take a look at the Boosterconf program for inspiration
- Feel free to ask your favorite AI assistant for help, but remember to do your own thinking

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Where can you submit your talk?

Keep your eyes open for the letters

CFP: Call for Presentations

CFS: Call for Speakers

How are conference talks selected?

Submission and review systems

Who reads your abstract, and what are they looking for?

Are new speakers welcome?

What to do when your talk is rejected

THE BIG TECH CONFERENCES

- Booster 2027 (open right now, just for us!)
- Hello Stavanger
- TDC
- Javazone
- NDC Oslo

THE NICHE CONFERENCES

- Sikkerhetsfestivalen på Lillehammer
- Cloud Native
- KI i offentlig sektor
- Testkonferansen Odin
- Make data smart Bergen
- UXNorge innsiktsdagen

In groups

What conference(s) would be relevant for you talk idea?

Remember that you can submit to more than one 🚀

http://andrev.github.io/speaker-workshop/

Q&A

What are your questions about getting talks accepted and speaking at conferences?

Feedback?